

GODS OF OLYMPUS

Deities of Ancient Greece



Olympus was ruled by the stern and ruthless Zeus.

Although for centuries they were worshipped by the Greeks it remains unclear where the Gods of Olympus first originated—was it on Earth or in the pocket dimension of Olympus where they currently reside? Wherever they came from, their influence on this planet has faded over the last two millennia, although a handful of their number still walk the Earth.

THE GOLDEN AGE

Children of the Titans, the first generation of

the Olympian Gods were imprisoned in the underworld realm of Tartarus as soon as they were born, their father Cronos fearing that they would eventually overthrow him. His anxiety proved to be well founded: the last of his children, Zeus, avoided being incarcerated and, when he was old enough, freed his siblings and led a ten-year-long war against Cronos.

Victorious, Zeus and his siblings became the Gods of Olympus, worshipped by peoples across Europe. It was only when Christianity began to dominate the Western world that the Gods chose to withdraw to the Olympus dimension and began to reduce their ties with the mortal realm.



The court of Zeus was a byword for feasting and revelry. While most enjoyed the carefree hedonism of the place, some, including Venus and Hercules, yearned for a slightly more challenging existence.

Although most of the Gods departed a handful either remained on the Earth or returned, time and again, in the years that followed. Of those that stayed on Earth, Neptune (or Poseidon, as the Greeks called him) remained to watch over and be worshipped by the Atlanteans, while Hercules and Venus (Aphrodite to the Greeks) spent time living with mortals.

BACK TO EARTH

With the destruction of Asgard during Ragnarok, the Olympians became of a target of Amatsu-Mikaboshi, the Japanese god of evil. Mikaboshi led an attack on Olympus that was only repelled after both Ares and Hercules returned from Earth to help. Zeus was slain in the conflict and has not returned, although his body was not recovered.

During the Secret Invasion (see pp. 326-7), Hercules served as the Olympians' representative to the God Squad assembled to take down the Skrull gods. More recently, Hera and Pluto took control of the Olympus Group, the corporation that represents the Olympians' interests on Earth. Meddling directly in the affairs of mortals once again, they have decided to turn their company's resources toward one goal: killing both Athena and Hercules. **AD, MF**

Zeus did not entirely approve of the life his son, Hercules, had chosen to lead.

FACTFILE

NOTABLE GODS

- ZEUS** (Ruler of the Gods)
God of the Sky and Weather
- APOLLO** God of Light
- ARES** God of War
- ARTEMIS** Goddess of the Hunt
- ATHENA** Goddess of Wisdom
- ATLAS** Mountain God
- BELLONA** Goddess of Discord
- CUPID** God of Love
- DEIMOS** God of Terror
- DEMETER** Goddess of Fertility
- DIONYSUS** God of Wine
- GAEA** Mother-Earth
- HEBE** Goddess of Youth
- HEPHAESTUS** God of Fire
- HERA** Goddess of Marriage;
Queen of the Gods
- HERMES** God of Commerce and
Travel
- NEPTUNE (POSEIDON)**
God of the Sea
- NOX** God of Night
- PAN** God of Shepherds, Flocks
and Forests
- PERSEPHONE** Queen of the
Underworld
- PHOBOS** God of Fear
- PROMETHEUS** Titan of
forethought; benefactor of
mankind
- PSYCHE** Goddess of Fidelity and
Adoration
- TYPHON** God of Wind
- VENUS (APHRODITE)** Goddess
of Love and Beauty

BASE

Mount Olympus, Greece; later in
an otherdimensional world

FIRST APPEARANCE

Journey Into Mystery Annual #1
(1965)

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• Venus #1-5

The goddess Venus becomes editor of Beauty Magazine and helps bring couples together.

• Thor #126-131

Hercules fights Thor who then rescues him from the netherworld where he has been imprisoned. Their firm friendship is sealed.

• Avengers #281-285

Angered by injuries suffered by Hercules, Zeus attacks the Avengers and forbids the Olympus Gods from travelling to Earth.

